



GS-NEWS

G E O S C I E N C E & S U S T A I N A B I L I T Y N E W S

Issue 1 · September 2026

Hofstra University · Geology, Environment and Sustainability

What you can apply for, attend, or take next.

NEAREST DEADLINE

Paid Research at Brookhaven: 30 September, 5:00 PM Eastern Time

FROM THE EDITOR

This is the first issue of GS-NEWS, a monthly letter for students in Geology, Environment and Sustainability (GES). It carries one kind of thing: what you can apply for, attend, or take next. Deadlines, internships, scholarships, field trips, talks, courses, and the work students in this department are doing.

It comes out once a month during the academic year, September to May. Every deadline here was checked on 17 September 2026, against the own page of the organisation offering it. If a deadline has not been posted yet for next year, this letter says so instead of printing last year's date, which would send you to a closed application.

One thing worth knowing before you read on: some scholarships are not applied for directly. The university nominates you, which means there is an internal Hofstra deadline months before the national one. Those are marked below.

To keep receiving GS-NEWS, [subscribe here](#). To write for it, see the last section.

CLOSING SOON

Paid Research at Brookhaven

Science Undergraduate Laboratory Internships (SULI), spring 2027

Closes 30 September, 5:00 PM Eastern Time

A paid, full-time research internship for one semester at a national laboratory, working beside a staff scientist. Brookhaven National Laboratory in Upton is one of the seventeen participating laboratories, so this one is reachable without leaving Long Island. It is run by the Office of Science of the United States Department of Energy (DOE), and it pays a stipend with housing and travel allowances.

This is the spring term, so you would be away from campus in spring 2027. The summer 2027 round usually closes in January and is not posted yet.

Apply: science.osti.gov/wdts/suli

Fund Your Own Research

Sigma Xi Grants in Aid of Research

Closes 1 October

A small grant you apply for yourself, to pay the real costs of your own research: field travel, laboratory analyses, supplies. Sigma Xi is a scientific research society; it is open to any undergraduate or graduate student in a degree programme, and you do not need to be a member of Sigma Xi to apply.

Undergraduates can receive \$500 to \$2,000 if the student or the advisor is an active Sigma Xi member, and up to \$1,000 otherwise. There is a second cycle every 15 March.

If you have never applied for anything of this kind, this is a good first one. The application is short, and the money pays for work you want to do anyway.

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Apply: sigmaxi.org/programs/grants-in-aid-of-research

ON AND NEAR CAMPUS

Skip the Car for a Day

Car Free Day Long Island

Monday 22 September

Pledge to travel without a car for one day. Dr. Bennington plans to ride his bicycle to campus that day.

Real Jobs, Real Alumni

Alumni career talks in GEOL 005

15 and 22 October

Three graduates of this department come back to talk about the careers they built:

- ◆ Fran Grassia, environmental geology (15 October, 12:30 PM)
- ◆ Doug Ferraiolo, hydrology, more than a decade in the field (22 October, 11:30 AM)
- ◆ Marrakech Cunliffe, sustainability (22 October, 12:15 PM)

Gittleston 162, and on Zoom. [Whether a student outside GEOL 005 may attend is not confirmed yet; watch the next issue for an answer.]

Free Dinner, Real Geologists

Long Island Association of Professional Geologists

Next meeting in the winter

LIAPG holds a dinner meeting every quarter, with talks and panel discussions on working in environmental and geotechnical consulting. The association sponsors five students at each meeting, so those five eat for free, and the department can usually arrange a van from campus. The September meeting has passed. The next one is in the winter, and Dr. Bennington chooses who goes.

ONE OF OURS

Renee Lista, a graduate student in this department, was profiled in Hofstra News on 31 August for her work in sustainability. The article describes how she came to the field and what she is working on now.

Read it: news.hofstra.edu

LOOKING TO NEXT SUMMER

The summer positions below are decided in the winter, but the application work starts now.

Two Years of Tuition, Paid

Hollings Undergraduate Scholarship

Closes 31 January 2027, 11:59 PM Eastern Time

Two years of tuition support, up to \$9,500 each year, and a paid ten-week research internship at a facility of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

This one is for second-year students only, which is the fact most people get wrong. You must be a full-time second-year student in a four-year programme, or a third-year student in a

five-year programme, or a student transferring from a community college (a two-year college) to a four-year institution. You must be a citizen of the United States and hold a cumulative grade point average of at least 3.0. Eligible subjects include environmental, oceanic, atmospheric and biological sciences, geography, physics, hydrology, mathematics, engineering, remote sensing, and computer and information science.

Applications opened on 1 September 2026.

Apply: noaa.gov/office-education/hollings-scholarship

Summer Job: National Park

Scientists in Parks, summer 2027

Applications open in mid-December

A paid placement in a national park doing real resource work: geological mapping, monitoring, geographic information systems, and explaining the park's science to visitors. It is run by the National Park Service with the Geological Society of America (GSA).

One line from their own page is worth repeating: positions close once they receive 60 applications. Applying in the first days of the cycle matters more here than in most places.

Details: scientistsinparks.org/how-to-apply

Paid Research, an Hour Away

Lamont-Doherty Summer Intern Program

2027 dates not posted yet. Watch from early January

Ten weeks of paid summer research in Earth, ocean, atmospheric and environmental science at Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory in Palisades, New York, about an hour from campus. The 2026 round paid a \$7,000 stipend with free accommodation in a hall of residence.

This is a Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) site of the National Science Foundation (NSF), and unusually it accepts students who have finished their second year, not only their third. Students in their final year are not eligible. Some of the positions are funded by the REU award, which is open only to citizens and permanent residents of the United States; other positions are not REU-funded and are open to more students.

Their page says the summer 2027 round is not open yet. The 2026 round opened on 19 January.

Details: lamont.columbia.edu

Hofstra's Top Science Scholarship

Barry Goldwater Scholarship

Hofstra nominates. National deadline 29 January 2027

The main national scholarship for undergraduates who intend to become research scientists, open to second- and third-year students in the natural sciences, mathematics and engineering.

You cannot apply directly. Hofstra nominates its candidates, and the internal deadline comes first. **Dr. Matthew Smylie** is Hofstra's campus representative, the person who reviews internal applications and chooses who Hofstra nominates, and he is looking for candidates now. Hofstra has had three Goldwater scholars, all of them within the last six years.

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Ask Dr. Smylie about the internal process, or read Hofstra's own listing: sites.google.com/hofstra.edu/prestigious-scholarships

Three Years, Fully Funded

For final-year students: NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP)

Geosciences closes 23 October 2026, 8:00 PM Eastern Time

Three years of funded graduate study, applied for in your final year of college, before you have been admitted anywhere. It pays a \$37,000 stipend each year and \$16,000 towards the cost of education, for three years that you can use at any point within a five-year window of graduate study.

It is open to students in their final year, recent graduates, and first- and second-year graduate students who are citizens, nationals or permanent residents of the United States. Other subjects have different dates: Life Sciences 20 October, Computer and Social Sciences 22 October, Engineering 23 October. The people writing your references must send them about a week before you submit.

Apply: nsf.gov/funding/opportunities/grfp

NOT OPEN YET, WORTH WATCHING

Give Your First Talk

GSA Northeastern Section Meeting

Saratoga Springs, New York, 11 to 14 March 2027. Abstract deadline not posted yet

This is the regional geology conference, and it is where an undergraduate gives a first poster or talk to a real scientific audience. Undergraduate posters are common there, and welcome.

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The abstract deadline has not been posted. The GSA page currently says to check back in the autumn. Comparable section meetings have closed abstracts in early to mid December, so watch the page from late October.

Watch: geosociety.org/events/section-meetings/northeastern

\$2,000 for Your Project

Stephen G. Pollock Undergraduate Student Research Grants

Closes 10 April

Up to \$2,000 for your own undergraduate research project, from the Northeastern Section of GSA, which covers New York. It is for second- and third-year students who are student members of GSA, and it expects the results to be presented at a GSA meeting.

Presenting the results is a requirement, not a suggestion: this grant and the Saratoga Springs meeting above work as a pair. The grant pays for the work, and the meeting is where you present it.

Details: geosociety.org/northeastern-section

WRITE FOR GS-NEWS

GS-NEWS is looking for student contributing editors, whose names are printed at the top of every issue they work on.

What contributors write:

- ◆ A first-person account of an internship, a field season, or a summer project
- ◆ Your own research finding, written so that a first-year student understands it
- ◆ A report from an event, a field trip or a conference, with photographs
- ◆ A profile of a student in the department, or of a graduate and where they are now
- ◆ Anything about student life in GES that other students would want to know

None of it is scientific writing.

It is writing for people outside your subject, which is a separate skill and a useful one to have.

To contribute a piece, or to join as a contributing editor for the year, write to the editor with GS-NEWS in the subject line.

GS-NEWS is published for students of the Department of Geology, Environment and Sustainability at Hofstra University. Founding Editor: Dr. Antonios E. Marsellos. Every date is checked against the source before publication. If you find an error, write to the editor and it will be corrected in the next issue.